

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Wednesday, 05 August 2026 · 21:08 IST
Prepared by Kore.ai Competitive Intelligence

Bottom line: Competitors are aggressively pushing AI agent capabilities, particularly in regulated sectors and voice, but often struggle with pricing predictability and independent validation, creating clear openings for Kore.ai's proven, deterministic platform.

Agentforce Secures IL5 Authorization, Expanding Public Sector Reach

WHAT HAPPENED
Salesforce's Agentforce has achieved U.S. Army Human Resources Command (HRC) IL5 authorization, enabling its deployment for 24/7 AI-powered support within the public sector. This includes deployments for Missionforce National Security, highlighting a strategic push into government operations. (2026-08-05) [MeriTalk](#) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
While Agentforce targets a specific niche with government authorization, its reliance on a broader platform and potential for data lock-in contrasts with Kore.ai's provider-agnostic approach and proven enterprise-grade governance. We should highlight our established analyst leadership in conversational AI for customer service, underscoring our platform's broader applicability and independence.

IBM watsonx Orchestrate Enhances Agentic Capabilities with Self-Improvement and Personalization

WHAT HAPPENED
IBM's watsonx Orchestrate platform is introducing self-improving agents, personalized chat experiences, and faster workflows, aiming to close the gap in banking AI with event-driven systems. (2026-08-03) [IBM](#) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
IBM's focus on self-improvement and personalization, while valuable, still operates within a complex ecosystem and faces analyst critiques regarding platform overlap and a slip to Challenger status in Gartner's Conversational AI MQ. Kore.ai's ABL offers compile-time validation and deterministic execution, providing a more robust and auditable foundation for enterprise CX, especially in regulated industries, compared to IBM's probabilistic approach.

Sierra and Plaid Partner for AI-Driven Financial Workflows, Granting Live Bank Account Access

WHAT HAPPENED
Sierra has partnered with Plaid to enable its AI agents to access live bank accounts, aiming to transform AI agents into actionable financial workflows. This collaboration targets the next era of AI-powered finance. (2026-08-03) [PYMNTS.COM](#) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
This partnership signifies a move by Sierra into deeper financial integrations, but it also highlights potential governance and security concerns with granting live bank account access to AI agents. Kore.ai's ABL and robust governance framework, including compile-time validation and permission-scoped knowledge retrieval, offer a more secure and auditable approach for sensitive financial transactions, mitigating the risks associated with direct, live access.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
Agentforce (Salesforce)	(2026-08-05) Achieves U.S. Army HRC IL5 authorization for public sector deployment — MeriTalk	Med	Highlight analyst leadership in CX conversational AI and platform independence.
IBM Agent Platform	(2026-08-03) Introduces self-improving agents and personalized chat in watsonx Orchestrate — IBM	Med	Emphasize ABL's compile-time validation and deterministic execution for enterprise trust.
Sierra	(2026-08-03) Partners with Plaid for AI agents to access live bank accounts — PYMNTS.com	Med	Highlight Kore.ai's robust governance and security for sensitive financial data.
Parloa	(2026-08-04) Study indicates older consumers are loyal to AI-powered customer service — PR Newswire	Low	Emphasize Kore.ai's proven omnichannel capabilities and broader enterprise analyst validation.
Five9	(2026-08-04) Seeks noninfringement ruling to avoid litigation — Bloomberg Law News	Low	Focus on our platform's stability and proven track record, contrasting with litigation risks.

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- Continued expansion of Agentforce into regulated government sectors.
- Further integration of Plaid's capabilities into Sierra's AI agent offerings.
- IBM's ongoing efforts to consolidate watsonx Orchestrate and Assistant for clearer CX positioning.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Reinforce Kore.ai's position as a Leader in independent CX conversational AI evaluations (Gartner, Forrester) in all messaging.
- Emphasize ABL's compile-time validation and deterministic execution as key differentiators for regulated industries and predictable TCO.
- Arm sales with specific talking points on the governance and security advantages of Kore.ai's platform over solutions granting direct access to sensitive data.
- Monitor the competitive landscape for further consolidation and partnerships that may create platform lock-in or integration complexities.

- Highlight Kore.ai's true omnichannel capabilities as a distinct advantage over voice-first or digitally-focused solutions.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- [MeriTalk](#)
- [IBM](#)
- [PYMNTS.com](#)
- PR Newswire
- [Bloomberg Law News](#)